

The Complete Diabetes-Friendly Cooking Masterclass

Delicious Recipes. Smart Strategies. Better Blood Sugar.

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Disclaimer

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My Personal Journey

Five years ago, I was diagnosed with Type 2 diabetes. Unlike many people who face this diagnosis, I didn't have to overhaul my entire diet — as a trained French and Mediterranean chef, I already cooked with market-fresh ingredients, seasonal produce, and high-quality staples. Freshness has always been the heart of my cooking.



The real shift came in how I prepared my favorites. I began redeveloping diabetes-friendly versions of beloved classics, making smart swaps to reduce refined carbs and sugars while protecting everything I care about: flavor, color, texture, and satisfaction.

This course gathers my recipes, chef tips, and cooking strategies so you can manage diabetes **without giving up the pleasure of eating.

This journey shaped my teaching, too. My classes and tutorials have always focused on using fresh ingredients in everyday menus and transforming them into vibrant meals. Now, I also show you how to do it in a way that supports blood sugar balance — proving that health-conscious cooking can still be joyful, indulgent, and delicious.

Module 2

Pantry Essentials & Mise en Place

Mediterranean & Fresh Pantry Staples

- Healthy fats:extra virgin olive oil, avocados, nuts (almonds, walnuts, pistachios), seeds (chia, flax, pumpkin)
- Fresh herbs: parsley, dill, basil, thyme, oregano, rosemary
- Spices: cumin, coriander, paprika, turmeric, cinnamon
- Vegetables & fruit (lower GI): leafy greens, broccoli/cauliflower, tomatoes, zucchini, eggplant, peppers, berries, citrus
- Proteins:fresh fish (sea bass, salmon, cod), skinless poultry, eggs, legumes (chickpeas, lentils)
- Smart carbs (moderation): bulgur, quinoa, barley; whole-grain bread; sweet potato
- Condiments: tahini, low-sodium soy sauce, vinegars (balsamic, red wine, apple cider), sugar-free tomato paste



Chef's Note: Whenever possible, choose fresh, market produce. I rarely use canned or frozen foods — fresh tastes better, cooks better, and gives you more control over flavor and texture. If fresh is unavailable, choose minimally processed alternatives and read labels carefully.



Printable Mise en Place Guide (Overview)

Mise en place means “everything in its place.” It’s the chef’s secret to calm, efficient cooking.

1. Read the recipe twice (spot timing & prep).
2. Gather all ingredients & tools (within arm’s reach).
3. Wash, chop, measureeverything in advance.
4. Arrange by order of use (first → last).
5. Set up tools & pans (clean, dry, ready).
6. Clean as you go (cloth & bin nearby).

👨‍🍳 Chef’s Tip: Mise en place prevents mistakes and frees your brain to focus on flavor and timing.



Mise en Place Mastery - The Chef's Secret to Effortless Cooking

Why it matters: reduces stress, saves time, prevents missed ingredients, improves results.

(Tagine example):

- Bowl 1: onions & garlic
- Bowl 2: pre-measured spices
- Bowl 3: preserved lemon & olives
- Jug: broth

Arrange left-to-right = cooking order

👩‍🍳 Pro tips: small prep bowls, large stable cutting board, label when multi-tasking, start with a clear counter.

Bonus Download: Printable Mise en Place Checklist (see Module 5 Bonus #1).



Module 3
Savory Recipes



Moroccan Chicken Tagine with Olives & Preserved Lemon

serves: 4 **Prep time: 15 mins** **Cook Time:** 1 hours

Ingredients

- 4 bone-in, skin-on chicken thighs (or mix thighs/drumsticks)
- 2 tbsp extra virgin olive oil
- 1 large onion, thinly sliced
- 3 garlic cloves, minced
- 1½ tsp ground ginger
- 1½ tsp ground cumin
- 1 tsp ground turmeric
- 1 tsp sweet paprika
- 1 cinnamon stick
- 1 cup low-sodium chicken broth
- 1 preserved lemon, rind only, rinsed & thinly sliced
- 1 cup green olives (preferably unpitted)
- Sea salt & black pepper
- Chopped parsley or coriander, for garnish

Chef's Tip: For a silkier sauce, swirl in a teaspoon of olive oil off the heat.



Directions

1. Heat oil in tagine/Dutch oven. Season chicken; brown 5–6 min on both sides. Then, remove chicken from pot.
2. Add onion; soften 5 min. Stir in garlic & spices + cinnamon; cook 1–2 min.
3. Return chicken; add broth. Simmer covered 40 min, turning once.
4. Add preserved lemon & olives; cook uncovered 10–15 min to reduce.
5. Garnish with herbs. Serve with salad or cauliflower couscous (see recipe 7).

Caramelized Cabbage with Spiced Tomato & Herbs

serves: 4 **Prep time: 10 mins** **Cook Time:** 45 mins

Ingredients

- ¼ cup tomato paste
- 3 garlic cloves, finely grated
- 1½ tsp ground coriander
- 1½ tsp ground cumin
- 1 tsp crushed red pepper flakes (to taste)
- 1 medium head green or savoy cabbage (\~900 g / 2 lb), cut into 8 wedges
- ½ cup olive oil, divided
- Salt
- 3 tbsp chopped dill, parsley, or cilantro
- Greek yogurt / sour cream / crème fraîche, to serve

👩‍🍳 Chef's Tip: Fantastic centrepiece for a veg-forward meal.



Directions

1. Mix tomato paste, garlic, coriander, cumin, red pepper.
2. Sear salted cabbage in ¼ cup oil (med-high) \~4 min/side; remove.
3. Add remaining oil; cook spice paste 2–3 min until darkened.
4. Add 1½ cups water; season; simmer. Nestle cabbage in.
5. Bake uncovered 30–40 min, turning halfway, until tender & caramelized.
6. Finish with herbs; serve with a dollop of yogurt.

Turkish Eggplant with Tomato & Garlic (İmam Bayıldı)

serves: 4 **Prep time: 15 mins** **Cook Time:** 1 hour

Ingredients

- 2 large eggplants, halved lengthwise
- ¼ cup olive oil (plus more to brush)
- 1 onion, finely chopped
- 4 garlic cloves, minced
- 2 cups diced fresh tomatoes
- 1 tsp ground cumin
- Salt & pepper
- 2 tbsp chopped parsley

Directions

1. Score eggplant flesh; brush with oil; roast cut-side down 25 min.
2. Sauce: sauté onion in oil 5 min; add garlic 1 min; add tomatoes, cumin, salt/pepper; simmer 10 min.
3. Flip eggplant; spoon over sauce; bake 15 min more.
4. Garnish with parsley; serve warm or room temp.

👨‍🍳 Chef's Tip: Classic served at room temperature — perfect for mezze.



Greek Baked Fish with Lemon, Herbs & Olive Oil

serves: 4 **Prep time: 10 mins** **Cook Time:** 15-20 mins

Ingredients

- 4 firm white fish fillets or 1 whole fish (sea-
- bass, cod, snapper)
- 3 tbsp extra virgin olive oil
- 1 lemon (½ juiced, ½ sliced)
- 3 garlic cloves, thinly sliced
- 2 tbsp chopped parsley
- 1 tsp fresh oregano leaves
- Salt & pepper

Directions

1. Place fish in baking dish; drizzle oil; season.
2. Scatter garlic; add lemon slices; sprinkle herbs.
3. Bake 15–20 min until fish flakes.
4. Finish with lemon juice.

👩‍🍳 Chef's Tip: Pair with roasted zucchini or a simple tomato-cucumber salad.



Italian Zucchini Noodles with Pesto & Cherry Tomatoes

serves: 4 **Prep time: 10 mins** **Cook Time:** 5 mins

Ingredients

- 2 medium zucchini, spiralized
- 1 cup cherry tomatoes, halved
- 2 tbsp extra virgin olive oil
- ¼ cup pesto (no added sugar)
- 2 tbsp grated Parmesan (optional)
- Salt & pepper

Directions

1. Sauté tomatoes in oil 2–3 min (med).
2. Add zoodles; toss 1–2 min until just tender.
3. Off heat, stir in pesto; season; sprinkle Parmesan.

👨‍🍳 Chef's Tip: Keep zoodles al dente to avoid excess moisture.



Mediterranean Lentil Salad with Herbs & Feta

serves: 4 **Prep time: 10 mins** **Cook Time:** 15-20 mins

Ingredients

- 1 cup dried green/brown lentils, rinsed
- 2 cups low-sodium veg broth (or water)
- 1 cup diced cucumber
- 1 cup cherry tomatoes, halved
- ½ cup red onion, finely diced
- ¼ cup chopped parsley
- 2 tbsp chopped mint
- 3 tbsp extra virgin olive oil
- Juice of 1 lemon
- ½ cup feta, crumbled
- Pepper + a pinch of salt

Directions

1. Simmer lentils in broth 15–20 min until tender; drain; cool.
2. Toss lentils with veg & herbs.
3. Whisk oil + lemon; season; dress salad.
4. Top with feta.

👩‍🍳 Chef's Tip: Tastes even better the next day.



Moroccan Spiced Cauliflower “Couscous

serves: 4 **Prep time: 10 mins** **Cook Time:** 6-8 mins

Ingredients

- 1 large head cauliflower, riced
- 2 tbsp olive oil
- 1 tsp ground cumin
- ½ tsp turmeric
- ½ tsp ground cinnamon
- ¼ cup chopped parsley
- ¼ cup toasted almonds or pine nuts
- Salt & pepper

Directions

1. Heat oil; add cauliflower rice & spices; sauté 5–6 min until tender.
2. Season; fold in parsley; top with nuts.

👨‍🍳 Chef’s Tip: Ideal base for the tagine’s sauce.



Module 4
Desserts & Sweet Treats



Greek Yogurt Parfait with Berries & Nuts

serves: 4 **Prep time: 10 mins** **Cook Time:** 6-8 mins

Ingredients

- 1 cup full-fat Greek yogurt (unsweetened)
- ½ cup mixed berries (blueberries/raspberries/strawberries)
- 2 tbsp chopped walnuts/almonds
- 1 tsp chia seeds, ½ tsp cinnamon
- Optional: 1 tsp raw honey or sugar-free sweetener

Directions

Layer yogurt → berries → nuts/chia → cinnamon; drizzle lightly if using honey.

👨‍🍳 Tip: Seasonal berries = best flavor & lower sugar.



Dark Chocolate Almond Clusters

serves: 8 clusters **Prep time: 10 mins** **Chill Time:** 30 mins

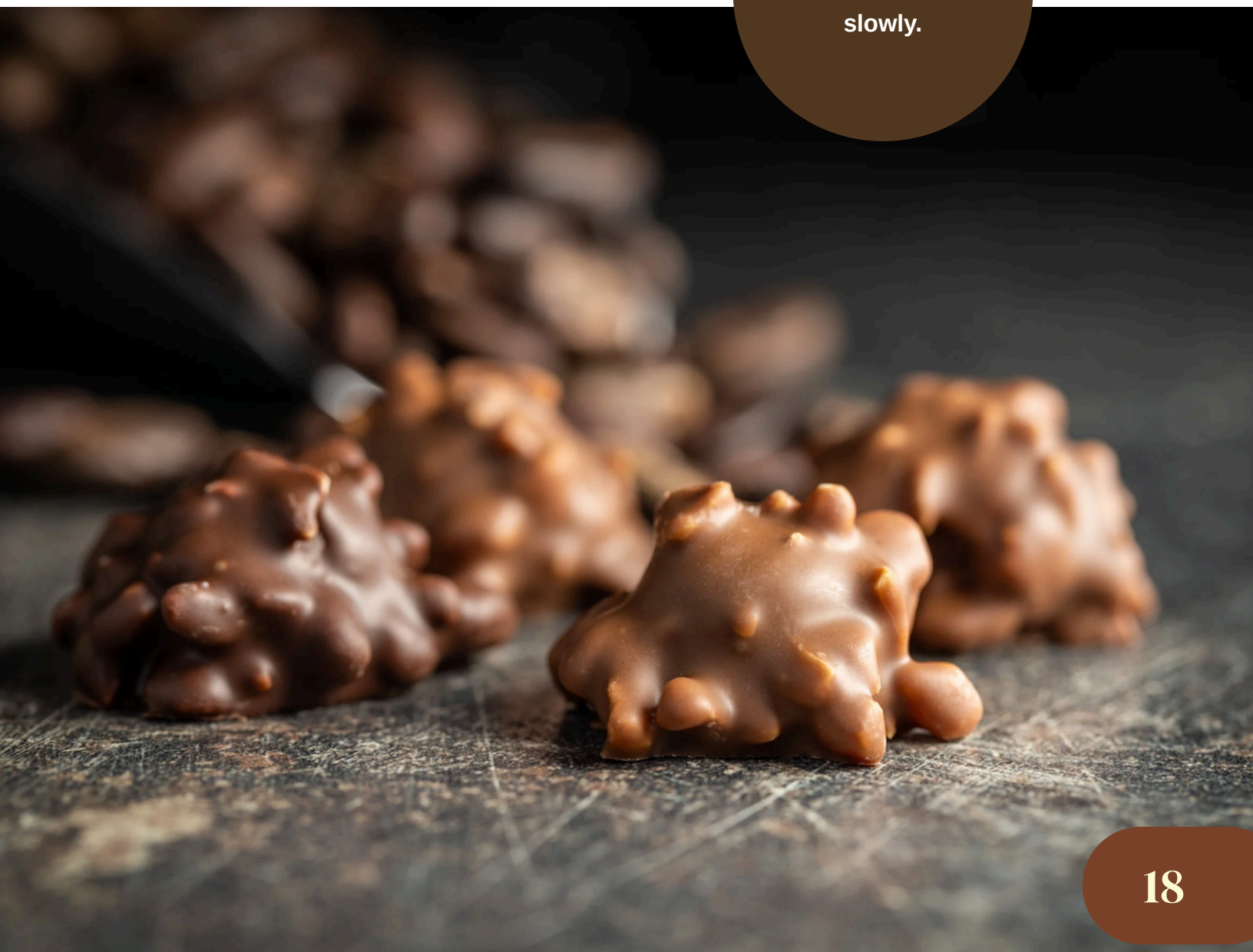
Ingredients

- 100 g (3.5 oz) dark chocolate (85% cocoa)
- ½ cup whole almonds (raw or lightly roasted, unsalted)

Directions

1. Melt chocolate; stir in almonds; spoon onto parchment; chill until set.

👩‍🍳 Tip: Portion small and savor slowly.



Baked Cinnamon Apples with Greek Yogurt

serves: 4 | Prep time: 10 mins | Bake: 25 min

Ingredients

- 4 apples, cored
- 2 tsp cinnamon, 2 tsp butter, ½ tsp vanilla
- ½ cup Greek yogurt (to serve)

Directions

Place apples in dish; add cinnamon, butter, vanilla; bake 25 min; serve with yogurt.

👩‍🍳 Tip: Add crushed walnuts or pistachios for crunch. My personal preference is pistachios.



Almond & Orange Biscotti (Sugar-Free)

serves: 20 | Prep time: 15 mins | Cook Time:20 + 10 mins

Ingredients

- 1½ cups almond flour
- ½ cup chopped almonds
- 2 eggs
- ½ cup erythritol/monk fruit
- Zest of 1 orange
- 1 tsp baking powder

Directions

Mix dry; beat in eggs; form log; bake 20 min; cool slightly; slice; bake 10–12 min to crisp.



👨‍🍳 **Tip: Perfect with coffee or mint tea.**

Chia Pudding with Coconut Milk & Pistachios

serves: 4 | Prep time: 5 mins | Chill: overnight

Ingredients

- ½ cup chia seeds
- 2 cups unsweetened coconut (or almond) milk
- 1 tsp vanilla, sweetener to taste
- 2 tbsp chopped pistachios

Directions

Stir all but nuts; whisk again after 10 min; chill overnight; top with pistachios.

Tip: Add a drop of rosewater for a Mediterranean note.



Module 5
Extra Value Tips & Resources

1) Kitchen Time-Saver Tips

- Wash and chop vegetables for the week; store them in airtight containers.
- Batch-roast vegetables and double soups, stews, sauces, or dressings; freeze labeled portions.
- Cook once, eat twice: roast extra protein for salads or bowls the next day.
- Freeze chopped herbs in olive oil, or keep a flavor tray of herbs, garlic, lemon, and olive oil.
- Build sheet-pan dinners with protein, vegetables, and herbs for minimal cleanup.

2) Smart Carb Swaps (and Why)

- White rice → cauliflower rice or bulgur (more fiber).
- Refined pasta → zucchini noodles, spaghetti squash, or chickpea pasta.
- White bread → whole-grain or sprouted bread (slower absorption).
- Mashed potatoes → cauliflower or celeriac for a lighter, creamy side.
- Bread crumbs → crushed nuts or almond flour; choose lentils or chickpeas for extra fiber and protein.

3) Build Big Flavor Without Added Sugar

- Acid: brighten dishes with lemon juice, zest, or vinegar.
- Spices: toast cumin, coriander, paprika, cinnamon, nutmeg, or cardamom.
- Herbs and olive oil: finish with parsley, dill, mint, basil, or a fragrant drizzle.
- Roast vegetables or slowly caramelize onions and cabbage to develop natural sweetness.

Prepping, Chopping, Sautéing









Build a Balanced Plate

Use this simple visual formula as a flexible starting point for balanced, satisfying meals.

1/2 PLATE

Non-Starchy Vegetables

Leafy greens, broccoli, cauliflower, peppers, zucchini, or mushrooms.

1/4 PLATE

Protein

Fish, chicken, eggs, tofu, beans, or plain Greek yogurt.

1/4 PLATE

High-Fiber Carbohydrate

Lentils, chickpeas, bulgur, brown rice, sweet potato, or whole grains.

FINISH WITH

Healthy Fat + Flavor

Olive oil, avocado, nuts, seeds, herbs, citrus, or spices.

Make It Your Own

Pair the plate elements in ways that suit your culture, preferences, schedule, and appetite.

Portion needs vary. Follow your personal diabetes care plan and notice how different meals affect your glucose.

Bonus #1
Printable Mise en Place Checklist

Mise en place — “everything in its place” — is your foundation for stress-free, joyful cooking. Use this printable checklist to prepare like a pro:

1. Read the Recipe Fully – Know every step before you start.
2. Gather Ingredients & Tools – Have everything within arm’s reach.
3. Wash & Chop Ingredients – Prepare before cooking begins.
4. Measure Ingredients – Accuracy ensures success.
5. Arrange in Cooking Order – Keep the flow smooth.
6. Clean as You Go – A tidy station keeps you focused.
7. Label if Needed – For multi-step recipes or cooking with others.

👩‍🍳 Chef’s Tip: The few minutes you spend setting up will save you twice as much time during cooking.

Bonus #2
Mediterranean Mezze Platter

Introduction

A mezze platter is more than just food — it's a Mediterranean tradition of sharing, tasting, and connecting. This printable guide shows you how to create a balanced, diabetes-friendly mezze spread that delights every palate.

Suggested Components:
- Hummus made with extra lemon and olive oil
- Smoky baba ganoush
- Marinated olives and artichokes
- Grilled seasonal vegetables
- Fresh tomato-cucumber salad
- Slices of whole-grain or low-carb Turkish flatbread

👩‍🍳 Chef's Tip: Arrange items with a mix of colors, textures, and flavors for maximum appeal.



Starter platter suggestions:

- **Dips**

Hummus, baba ganoush, tzatziki

- **Veg**

Cucumber sticks, cherry tomatoes, radishes, grilled zucchini/peppers

- **Extras**

Olives, feta cubes, stuffed grape leaves (brown rice), smoked salmon

- **Bread**

Turkish flatbread**, pita, or lavash — warmed, cut into modest wedges

👩‍🍳 Chef's Tip: Garnish dips with olive oil, paprika, and chopped herbs for instant restaurant polish.



Module 6
Quizzes & Progress Check



Quiz 1 – Pantry Essentials

1. Name three Mediterranean fresh herbs.
2. Which fat is central to the cuisine and heart-healthy?
3. Best place to source produce for flavor/quality?
4. Name one acceptable canned item if fresh isn't available.
5. True/False: Frozen/canned veg should always be your first choice.



Answer Key:

1. Any of: parsley, dill, basil, oregano, thyme, rosemary.
2. Extra virgin olive oil.
3. Farmers markets or specialty food stores.
4. Chickpeas or lentils (rinsed).
5. False — fresh is preferred when possible.

Module 6
Quizzes & Progress Check



Quiz 2 – Mise en Place Mastery

1. What does “mise en place” mean?
2. List two benefits.
3. True/False: Start cooking, then prep ingredients as you go.
4. Name one tool that helps keep prep organized.
5. In what order should ingredients be arranged?



Answer Key:

1. Everything in its place.
2. Reduces stress; saves time; prevents mistakes; improves results.
3. False.
4. Small prep bowls / large cutting board / labeled containers.
5. In order of use.

Module 6
Quizzes & Progress Check

Quiz 3 – Recipe Modifications for Diabetes

1. Best swap for white pasta in this course?
2. A lower-GI alternative to white rice?
3. True/False: Dark chocolate (85%) can fit in small portions.
4. Which fruit group is generally lower in sugar: berries or tropical?
5. Why is Greek yogurt useful in desserts?

Answer Key:

1. Zucchini noodles (or chickpea pasta).
2. Cauliflower rice (or bulgur in moderation).
3. True.
4. Berries.
5. Higher protein, lower carbs, creamy texture.

Module 7
Wrap-Up & Next Steps

🍾 **Congratulations — you did it!**

You've stocked a smart pantry, mastered mise en place, cooked savory and sweet dishes, learned simple swaps, and proved that eating for health can be full of flavor and pleasure.

A personal note from Chef Eliane:

Food should never feel like the enemy. With fresh ingredients, balanced techniques, and a chef's mindset, you can cook with confidence and joy — every day.

What's Next?

1. Holiday & Event Menu Planning E-Guide (Coming Soon)

A downloadable guide with ready-to-use menus, shopping lists, recipes, and a practical mise en place timeline for stress-free hosting.

2. Healthy Mediterranean Desserts Collection (Coming Soon)

A downloadable collection of satisfying sweet recipes designed with everyday balance in mind.

3. Step-by-Step Cooking Tutorials for All Skill Levels

Downloadable written tutorials featuring delicious recipes and practical techniques for health-conscious cooking without sacrificing flavor.



Bonuses (download & print):
Mise en Place Checklist (PDF)
Mediterranean Mezze Platter Guide (PDF)
Thank you for cooking with me.

Eliane Muskus, Chef & Founder, Epicurean Flow